New Healing Headquarters

The remarkable rise of AIIMS Jodhpur as a leading medical college is built upon a unique blend of classroom teaching, varied clinical experience, focus on research and close mentorship by faculty

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On September 17, 2012, when AIIMS Jodhpur was established with 50 students, three commitments were made to ensure quality medical education. Dr Shilpi Gupta Dixit, present acting Dean (academics) and professor (anatomy), recalls them clearly. "Patient care, research and public health were three unique aspects that AIIMS Jodhpur chose to focus upon," she says. "We had AIIMS Delhi as our model and mentor. It was our vision statement to be as good, or next as good as them," she adds. That aim seems to have been realised. Indeed, for many, AIIMS Jodhpur is the second preference after AIIMS Delhi. "I am sure I won't make it to AIIMS Delhi.... I have been targeting a seat at AIIMS Jodhpur throughout. It is as good and is part of a safer city," says Payal Varma, 17, who sat for the NEET UG exams this year.

In 2020, the faculty here contributed 409 research papers; this year, it has been 3,869. "We are the first for research amongst the new AIIMS," says Dr Goverdhan Dutt Puri, executive di-

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"We have significantly improved the diagnostic facilities because of which we now get 1.3 to 1.4 million OPD patients every year. The practical exposure and academic wisdom from our faculty is what has begun attracting some of the best medical students to our institute"

DR GOVERDHAN DUTT PURI
Executive Director, AIIMS Jodhpur